PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Nissan Patrol 60 Series

1960–1980 · 60 · G60 · K60 · KG60

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Rust in the usual places**
  SNLC's restoration needed new rear floor steel, fender kick-vent repairs and new metal under the gearbox crossmember. A 1965 on BaT had rust through the driver's footwell. He also found that Nissan didn't seam-seal the body seams on early trucks, so rust starts inside the joints. Check floors, footwells, kick vents, door bottoms and the crossmember under the transmission mounts.

- [ ] **US-delivered or imported?**
  US trucks were short-wheelbase L60 and KL60s with 80-mph speedometers. A 1965 on BaT with a US-market chassis number (4-L60-02697) had one, while Colombian trucks show km/h. Many 60s now for sale in the US came from Colombia in the past few years. Check the import papers and title, and that the chassis plate matches.

- [ ] **Transfer-case seals and the handbrake**
  SNLC says it's common for old Patrols to blow the front or rear output seals on the transfer case, and a leaking rear seal ruins the transmission-mounted drum handbrake. Look for oil on the handbrake drum and ask whether the parking brake actually holds. One 1967 on BaT had no working parking brake.

- [ ] **Brakes that work on all four wheels**
  These are four-wheel drum trucks. One BaT 1967 had its rear brakes disabled. SNLC had none of four master cylinders good enough to use without boring and sleeving. Budget for wheel cylinders, hoses and a master cylinder unless the seller has receipts.

- [ ] **Front swivels and axle joints**
  Early trucks used Tracta joints and later ones Birfields, according to SNLC. Pitted knuckle balls are the big problem: without a smooth surface for the seal, he warns, keeping the knuckle dry is very difficult. Look for weeping swivel seals and play at the top and bottom of each wheel.

- [ ] **Original engine and fuel system**
  The P six used a single-barrel Hitachi carburettor. Some BaT trucks now run electric fuel pumps that bypass the mechanical pump, and one has an aluminium radiator and a plastic tank. Those changes are reasonable on a driver but worth knowing on a 'correct' restoration.

- [ ] **Dealer options worth money**
  A front PTO winch (Koenig, with Nissan's PTO box) and 1960s Warn hubs are period US dealer options. SNLC says a complete PTO assembly can sell for $1,000 among Patrol people, and that only about a quarter of US trucks had a PTO winch.

- [ ] **Mileage and paperwork**
  Five-digit odometers have rolled or been replaced on many trucks. Several recent BaT listings were sold with 'true mileage unknown'. Judge on condition and documented work, not the odometer.

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- [ ] **US-market trucks**
  Restorer SNLC says the US got short-wheelbase L60 soft-tops and KL60 hardtops, all with a three-speed and a C216 rear axle. A BaT US-market 1965 had chassis 4-L60-02697 and an 80-mph speedometer.
- [ ] **Imports**
  Colombian trucks on BaT show km/h speedometers and chassis numbers such as L60..., KL60... and, on 1980–82 LG-61 trucks, G61..., with four-speed gearboxes. Ask for the import paperwork.
- [ ] **Front axle joints**
  SNLC says early front axles (before about 1968) use Tracta joints and later ones Birfields.
- [ ] **Speedometer drive**
  Pre-1966 trucks drive the speedometer from the front of the transfer case; later trucks have a splined pinion behind the 4WD flange.
- [ ] **Fire Patrols**
  Wikipedia says the two-wheel-drive Fire Patrol lacks the 4×4 badge, transfer lever and front differential, but every Fire Patrol has a PTO lever for the pump.

NOTES

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